

Week 4 troubleshooting

What they see	Likely cause	What you do
package X is not in std	no go.mod / wrong import	go mod init student-management-system in backend/
directory prefix . does not contain main module	ran go tools outside module	cd into backend/
go run: cannot run *_test.go files	wrong files	run ./cmd/server
prints nothing / wrong file	ran an old main.go	show go run ./cmd/server
empty folders missing on GitHub	Git ignores empty dirs	add .gitkeep in each internal/*
go: go.mod file not found	nested wrong folder	one go.mod at backend/
trying to go get github.com/gin-gonic/gin	jumped ahead	stop — week 5
.env in the PR	never created ignore	add .gitignore; git rm --cached .env
binaries committed	built in-tree	ignore *.exe, server, bin/
Windows path / PowerShell	wrong shell	stay in Ubuntu (WSL)

Scaffold reset

```
rm -rf ~/epic-go/sms
mkdir -p ~/epic-go/sms/backend
cd ~/epic-go/sms/backend
go mod init student-management-system
# recreate folders + main.go from the handout
```

Do not paste the whole finished course repo. They must type the skeleton.